

WebAss Specification

Assignment objective:

Design and implement a web site. Specifically, to write a home page for yourself including information about your past, future aspirations and a reflection on your design.

This assignment tests 2 main skills - creating a live working web site and demonstrating some basic HTML/CSS skills.

A Note on Graphic Design

Web Systems is a course that includes quite a lot of basic computer science (algorithms, number systems, Boolean algebra, operating systems, security, networking). The assignment involves at least a basic understanding of HTML and CSS and how they are applied. A good assignment will also demonstrate at least a “commonsense” understanding of elementary graphic design – a topic which is somewhat different in scope to the rest of the course. There is a set of powerpoint slides provided in this module that deal with the topic of graphic design as it relates to the assignment.

Requirements

You will make a website which is about yourself, which must obey the following specification. The actual content regarding yourself is not the important thing here and is not assessed. However, it must still of course be your own original work, not copied from any other source, and will be checked for plagiarism. You are free to expand on your interests and put only what you would like to, and there are no hard minimum or maximum word/content limits. The task is about your HTML/CSS and webpage design skills.

Your site will consist of 4 pages & 1 css file structured as follows. Note that the *websystems* directory is to be placed inside your home directory, not at the root!

- *websystems/index.html*
- *websystems/past.html*
- *websystems/future.html*
- *websystems/comments.html*
- *websystems/websystems.css*

You should place any extra files such as images (jpg, png etc.) into the *websystems* directory. They can also optionally be in subdirectories for neatness, for example *websystems/images* .

Your website must not depend on Javascript and should work even if CSS is disabled. It should also be usable and navigable if images and CSS are disabled.

Add to YouLearn

Minimum requirements

1. HTML 5
2. CSS 3
3. No embedded styles (including deprecated tags such as font or formatting attributes) or use of @import. ALL styles must be in *websystems.css* .
4. You must provide navigation between pages using HTML hyperlinks.
5. At least:
 1. 5 CSS classes
 2. 1 CSS id
 3. 1 div
 4. 1 span
 5. 1 table (NOT CSS tables)
 6. 1 list (any one of ordered, unordered, definition)
 7. 1 image (should not be large, e.g. over 1MB in size)

Page descriptions

index.html

This home page should be a short introduction to yourself and your website. Do not post private information here as this page will be public.

You must link to the other 3 pages (past.html, future.html, comments.html) from the home page. You must as a minimum use HTML anchors for this, but can also add other navigation methods if you wish, for example, clickable images. You should also include links back to the home page from the sub-pages. Even better is a consistent navigation method such as a menu bar on all pages.

You are permitted to obfuscate your personal information in the index/past pages as we respect your rights to privacy.

past.html

This page should describe your experiences with computing so far (eg: mention your HSC experience, past work experience).

future.html

This page should describe what you want to do with computing in the future.

comments.html

This page is one where the content, not only the execution, matters. The specific points you are required to comment on are:

- The overall structure of your website. What the pages are and how they interact. If you wish, you may include one or more diagrams to enhance the text in your description.
- The internal structure of each web page. If you wish, you may include one or more diagrams to enhance the text in your description.

Add to YouLearn

- A description of the styles used. This could be put in tabular form and could include the selector used, the type of selector, what the style does and where it is used.
- Discussion of the graphic design aspects of the site. This could include such topics as overall layout, colours used, typefaces used etc.
- Discussion of how the <alt> tag is used. Also discussion of how the site works when css is turned off. (The Firefox browser has a facility that allows CSS to be turned off).

websystems.css

This shall contain all the CSS styles used by your website.

- You should try to make this web site as appealing as possible, using style sheets only. You will lose marks for embedded or inline styles.
- You must NOT use 3rd party CSS frameworks such as bootstrap, w3.css, foundation, etc..

Testing

You can initially develop your pages using your own device by creating and editing the files on your local filesystem. You use your browser (e.g. chrome, safari, firefox) to open the pages without the need to run a web server.

You may use a HTML/CSS syntax aware editor such as Notepad++, Visual Studio Code, Bluefish etc. Alternatively, you could use this as an opportunity to practice your *vim* skills.

You MUST check the validation of your website at <http://validator.w3.org/> and your style sheet at <http://jigsaw.w3.org/css-validator/>. Generally, you can ignore 'information' messages, but warnings and especially errors are penalised.

To test that your pages work correctly when hosted by a server, before submission, you will need a hosting solution. The possible hosting solutions are outlined in the Introduction under Development Environment (options 1 and 3)

Submission

- You must submit via the EdStem system by Marking and submitting before the draft and final deadlines. Details are provided in Ed under the Assessment tab.
- The draft submission can be very preliminary in terms of content, but the key files and the correct directory structure must be there, and should be error free.
- Your assignment will be copied to an external web server for peer marking (to be announced later)
- If you are late, the Mark process will still work and the new version will be uploaded to the public site, but this may result in a late penalty as specified in the subject Information page.
- You will get zero (0) marks for websites email'ed, submitted erroneously on Canvas, or demonstrated by using the browser to directly load a HTML file (ie:

Add to YouLearn

file:// URL's.).

ANYTHING ELSE WILL NOT BE MARKED!

- Do not change the web site after the submission date - everything is data stamped so we will know. Your tutor may take up to 2 weeks to finalise the marking.

Prohibitions

- Do NOT use visual WYSIWYG tools such as Dreamweaver, Microsoft Expression, Microsoft Word, online HTML editors.
- Do NOT use 3rd party templates for your website
- Apart from HTML aware editors, do NOT use any tool that generates HTML/CSS code
- Do NOT use third party CSS/HTML/javascript libraries such as w3.css, bootstrap etc.
- Do NOT work as a group, this is an individual assignment.
- Your tutor may ask you to prove that you wrote this assignment by hand and not with assistance.

Fleshing out the Specification : reminders, hints, warnings

- Fundamentals: you MUST have the site layout exactly as described above :
 - do NOT change the filenames or directory location as we use an automated marking checker
 - make sure your files are in the *websystems* directory
 - make sure all file names and href/src attributes are in lower-case.
 - do NOT capitalise the first letter of filenames
 - **ensure files and directories have correct permissions!!**
 - unreadable or unusable web sites will also be penalised
- Technical detail :
 - Use HTML 5 and CSS 3.
 - do NOT use vendor specific tags or attributes – eg –webkit- -moz- etc as the validator may penalise you for this.
- do NOT use frames or iframes (this causes problem for the validator/assignment checker)
- additional marks WILL NOT be granted for features such as Flash, fancy graphics, animations, audio/video etc. Leave them out.
- watch out for "smart quotes" especially if you cut and paste from Microsoft Word.
- do NOT hard-code your page URL's inside your pages - your website should be "relative", i.e.: href's should NOT start with "http://" & will be penalised.
- You MUST use styles sheets to format your page. This MUST be in one CSS file, *websystems.css*
- dont use @import since the assignment checker won't pick this up.

Usability

- your web site MUST be easy to navigate and read (consider your target audience)
- we expect to be able to point and click, and not press the 'BACK' key to get to a page in extra URLs in the address bar. In other words, make sure the menu works on your site and that it works correctly.

Add to YouLearn

- make font sizes reasonable, use style sheets to manage them.
- if your tutor or peer marker can't read it, you will lose marks:
 - don't use bad colour combinations (for example, red on black, purple on black, purple on red, blue on purple, black on red)
 - recommend a maximum screen size should be 1024x768
- do not make pages so wide that they can't be read unless you scroll horizontally
- do not have large image or font files - keep pictures to less than 100kb, larger ones may attract penalties and/or create problems for the Ed workspace. - pay attention to the checker output

Ethics and Rules

- don't put advertisements or animations on your web site.
- do not put private information on your web site eg date of birth, home address, credit card details. This is a PUBLIC website.
- you **MUST** acknowledge graphic files downloaded from the internet. It is sufficient to put them in a HTML comment adjacent to the image tag. This is for legal copyright reasons as well as ethical ones.
- you **MUST NOT** use style sheets or designs from anyone else - this includes open source and commercial style sheets and frameworks eg bootstrap!
- this is an individual assessment, no group work is permitted
- you must not copy past assignments (this includes CSS components). Students suspected of cheating will have an academic misconduct allegation made to the university. Failure to take this seriously is a **fast track to failure** . (https://canvas.uts.edu.au/courses/40802/pages/how-to-be-successful-in-this-subject?module_item_id=2653617)
- your content must also be original. As usual, material quoted from the Internet or any other source must be referenced as you would in any other written assignment, following the UTS referencing guide for IT students. However as this assignment asks for you to REFLECT and COMMENT from your personal perspective, quoting other people's work is not needed and is easily avoided.

Robustness

- you **MUST** test your web site with graphics and Javascript turned off. Is it still usable? Firefox is the ideal browser to do this.
- you **SHOULD** check your web site on at two of the browsers - Chrome, Firefox, Safari and/or Microsoft Edge
- watch out for large JPG files from cameras - use a tool to reduce the size e.g. Microsoft Paint or Photoshop or GIMP
- do not use BMP or TIF files - these are not web friendly

Use available testing

- use the **Check** testing within Ed, don't rest until all errors are gone ! and you at least understand (most) warnings, why would you submit when you know

Add to YouLearn

- there are deductions for errors, warnings and access errors: Error: -0.5, Warning: -0.2, CSS Errors: -0.2, Access: (embedded style): -0.1 per item.
- total warning deductions are capped, and negative marks are not possible
- but do NOT rely on the Ed web preview function for **final** testing! you must submit versions via Check and later Mark early to allow yourself time to address any issues that become apparent when the page is 'live' - you may need several iterations to fix all errors. Don't submit first, then only notice errors after the deadline!!